

MINUTES OF MEETING



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PROJECT: Ohio River Trail Feasibility Study

DATE: April 14, 2010

ATTENDING: Doniele Andrus, Sean Garrigan, Timothy Stromberg, Bret Hollern, Jill Gaito,

Ann Toole (Toole Recreation Planning)

Jason Reyes (Greenways Incorporated)

Steering Committee Members

Note: See attached sign-in sheet for list of steering committee members in attendance

SUBJECT: Steering Committee Meeting #3

❖ General Comments

- The Sport Legacy Foundation currently owns the Montour Junction Property. Although the transfer of ownership to Allegheny County was targeted for late March, it is still pending.
- An overview of the corridor, by segment, was provided. Specific emphasis was discussed regarding the following areas:
 - The addition of a 10' side path to the existing and proposed portions of Woodlawn Road from the Center Township through the City of Aliquippa, Hopewell Township to the South Heights Borough line. Much of the proposed roadway reconstruction has been fully engineered and permitted and therefore the trail will require engineering design and permitting post construction (at least for the northern BCED portion).
 - The constraints of the riverfront alignment through South Heights Borough, including the Power Plant property and the active industrial properties south of the Plant in Crescent Township.
 - The need for an on-road route through portions of Crescent Township to connect the area between Maple and Main Streets. Alternatives for this area are still be explored.
 - The coordination and correspondence with the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers (ACOE) in the area of the Dasheild Lock and their proposed improvements to this facility and the process for requested trail access. The ACOE has been receptive to the concept and details on how this could be achieved will be provided in the draft document.
 - The feasibility of connecting the ACOE property to the proposed Moon Township waterfront park property near the Sewickley Bridge was discussed. This area was field-walked by the team and determined to be potentially feasible. Parcel ownership in this area is being researched to determine if CSX owns a parcel directly on the river's edge.

- Questions were raised regarding the speed of implementation and phasing for actual trail construction. These questions were addressed in the following statements
 - At this time the speed of the project's implementation and phasing depends on several key factors including level of participation and commitment from each municipality, cooperation between key stakeholders and availability of funding.
 - The scope of the project's implementation will be divided into key project segments/packages. This approach will help establish an implementation strategy that will forecast what can be done within 2 years, 5 years, 10 years, etc.
 - A potential approach to allow for segments of the project to be implemented faster is to package the projects between multiple funding sources and between (joint-venture) municipalities.
 - Ann Toole led a discussion regarding models for trail ownership and maintenance. She recommended developing a public/private non-profit partnership which could help speed up the implementation process as well as develop how the trail will be maintained after it is constructed.
 - A list will be developed of potential funding sources and grant opportunities as part of the study. Several EPA/HUD Grants were mentioned during the meeting including the EPA's new Pilot Grant for Area-wide Brownfields Planning and some potential PennVEST sources from the State.

❖ Data Requests and Comments

- Construction has been started on the new Route 51 Bridge over the existing CSX Right-of-Way. It was mentioned that the intersection of Route 51 and the Public/Private Drive of Industrial Blvd immediately adjacent to the Route 51 Bridge is a hazardous intersection with poor sight lines and truck traffic turning radii. This intersection has been historically hard to resolve due to complicated cooperation issues between key stakeholders impacted by its redesign. SGA will obtain information from PennDOT on the bridge design/alignment currently under construction.
- Water Works Park in Monaca is currently scheduled to start construction over the next several months.
- Meghan McNamara of Moon Twp. requested information on the distances of each of the alternatives under consideration. SGA will provide this information in the analysis section of the draft document provided in May.
- A suggestion was made to potentially post the Municipality questionnaire on the ORTC website to accompany the Draft ORT Draft documents to obtain a wider public response to the questionnaire. After the steering committee meeting several comments were provided which allow for a reduction in the wording on the survey document. The survey document was revised based on comments provided and sent to Doniele for distribution.
- BCED provided comments and edits to the Draft Ohio River Trail Vision Statement and Project Goals.

❖ Next Steps and Steering Committee Meeting(s) Schedule

- **The Next Steering Committee is scheduled to take place May 13th 2010 at 4pm Center Township building 224 Center Grange Road, Aliquippa, PA 15001.** A preliminary draft of the Ohio River Trail Feasibility Document will be distributed and introduced at the May 13th Meeting.
- **The June Steering Committee has been rescheduled for June 17th at 4pm. Location TBD.**
- A final set of field interviews will be performed in early May.
- Ann Toole will be contacting the designated individuals from each municipality to discuss community-specific issues related to possible ownership and maintenance organizational structures for the trail.

SIGN IN SHEET

Deekhar & H Crescent Township